EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Economics 10/2019 – 12/2026
Berlin School of Economics, Berlin, Germany (structured economics PhD, intake <4%, fully funded)

- Focus on Environmental Economics, Technological Change & Energy Transition
- Committee: Marion Dumas (LSE) | Ottmar Edenhofer (TU Berlin) | Jan Steckel (TUM)
- Research fellow at the **MIT Sloan** School of Management (3 months, academic host: Prof. Jacquelyn Pless)
- Research fellow at the **Grantham Research Institute** of Climate Change at **LSE** (1 year)
- Research fellow at **Imperial College London** (1 year, remotely)

Fellow Innovation Growth Lab (since 2025), seed grant (US$5k, 2026)

MSc International Trade, Finance and Development 09/2017 – 07/2018
Barcelona Graduate School of Economics

MSc Political Economy of Late Development (distinction, top 5%) 09/2011 - 09/2012
London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), London, UK

BSc International Economics and American Studies 10/2007 - 07/2011
University of Tübingen, Germany
Exchange year Universidade de São Paulo, Brazil 08/2009 - 07/2010

PUBLICATIONS (SELECTED)

Published (peer-reviewed)

Handler, N. and Brachert, M., 2026. Entrepreneurial ecosystems, economic complexity, and venture-oriented entrepreneurship in German regions. *Small Business Economics*, pp.1-26.

Handler, N., Löschel, A., Braun, M. and Grimm, V., 2025. Informing net-zero policies in the European Union with evidence-based approaches. *Nature Reviews Clean Technology*, *1*(6), pp.375-376. Link

Andres, P., Mealy, P., Handler, N. and Fankhauser, S., 2023. Stranded nations? Transition risks and opportunities towards a clean economy. *Environmental Research Letters*, *18*(4). Link

Esin, S., Handler, N., Morey, L., Munjal, A. 2022. "Randomised controlled trials: Can they inform the development of green innovation policies in the UK?" Policy insight. Grantham Research Institute on Climate Change and the Environment, London School of Economics. Link

Work in Progress:

Relatedness and Regional Development in Germany: Evidence on Skills, Technologies, Industries, and Complexity, Handler, N., Brachert, M., Kubis, A. *R&R Research Policy*

Reducing emissions in the laboratory: Evidence from a randomized evaluation of a sustainable practice and accreditation scheme, Handler, N., Rutnam, D., Harrington Ruiz, N.

Unlocking Innovation: Experimental Evidence on Barriers to Public R&D Funding Uptake, Handler, N.

Growing Clean? Directing Technological Change in Germany. Handler, N., Brachert, M.

Modeling the impact of IT- and AI-related emissions in a university setting, Poletto, M., Handler, N.

SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS (SELECTED)

• Conference on Field Experiments in Strategy (CFXS) (07/2026)
• Regis Summer School (06/2026) with Prof. Gaétan de Rassenfosse
• AFID User Workshop ZEW Mannheim (04/2026)
• Institut d'Economia de Barcelona, Universitat de Barcelona (2026)
• DRUID Innovation PhD Workshop, Aarhus (2026), DRUID conference Lisbon (2024)
• Innovation Growth Lab (virtual 2025, 2x; Amsterdam Workshop 2020)
• ifo Workshop Fürth (2025)
• Harvard Growth Lab (2023, 2024)
• European Union Joint Research Centre, Sevilla (2024)
• Advances in Field Experiments, Chicago (2023, 2026)
• WICK10 Turin (2023)

REVIEWING ACTIVITY

- Research Policy

TEACHING & SUPERVISION (SELECTED)

- Energy Data Lab : leveraging RCTs for Campus Decarbonization (secured CHF30k UZH funding) 2025, 2026
- HEC Paris — Lecturer, MBA Climate & Business Certificate: "Climate Policy and Green Growth" 2023

Nils Handler | Bionstrasse 4 | 8006 Zurich | + 41 78 264 00 62 | nils.handler@gmail.com | LinkedIn

- ETH Zurich, HEC & Hertie School Berlin : taught executive trainings on energy policy 2023, 2024,25
- MSc Dissertation Supervision : Nigel Yao (Oxford, distinction), Lewis Morrey (LSE), Apurva Munjal (LSE)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (SELECTED)

Office of the President, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland
Project Leader Climate Neutrality since 08/2024

- Built and lead an evidence-based decarbonization agenda; budget CHF 1.2M, leading five data scientists
- Developed the concept for the world's first university "buyers club" for durable carbon dioxide removal (CDR)
- Built a strategic partnership with Terralytiq for AI-supported product carbon footprinting; assessed the emissions impact of AI applications at the institution

Federal Institute for Geosciences and Natural Resources, Hannover, Germany
Economist & Project Manager, International Cooperation Program 09/2018 – 06/2021

- Modelled US$6.5B in climate-critical mineral procurement spend & built Tableau-recognised analytics infrastructure
- LION-tool presented to Ministry of Mines Permanent Secretary and German Ambassador, triggering cabinet briefing
- Coordinated stakeholders across Africa and Europe, led World Bank and OECD Natural Resource Policy Dialogue

World Bank, Washington D.C., USA
Economist working on Energy, Trade & Competitiveness, various Global Practices 12/2014 – 06/2023

- Led Mining Investment and Governance Review (MInGov): managing engagements & quality-control
- Organised global conference (budget >US$200K); Mapped green competitiveness policies across 25+ countries
- Drafted DRC Economic Memorandum: entrepreneurial ecosystem, skills mapping, and EV value-chain analysis

Inter-American Development Bank (IADB), Washington D.C., USA 09/2012 - 11/2014
Junior Economist & Carlo Schmid Fellow

- Quantitative and qualitative research on fiscal decentralisation and extractive industry revenue; 10+ publications
- Participated in Board Meetings; briefed Governors via constituency report for the IDB Annual Meeting

External Consultant (delivered remotely) 04/2024 – 07/2024

- **BMW Foundation**: Developed thematic strategy on energy resilience; delivered 10+ concept papers and storylines to new leadership team; supported global trade dialogue with Columbia University
- **Breakthrough Energy**: Led economic modelling for report: "Investing in Net Zero: Assessing Germany's venture capital potential in climate tech until 2030"

SKILLS (SELECTED)

- **Data Analysis :** STATA, R, Python, oTree, Qualtrics, Matlab, Tableau, MS Excel
- **Languages:** German (native), English (C2), Spanish (C2), Portuguese (C2), French (B1)

TRAININGS (SELECTED)

- Electricity Markets (Lion Hirth) 2024
- Using Text as Data: Methods and Applications, Barcelona School of Economics 2022
- Economic Foundations for Energy and Climate Policy, DIW Berlin 2019

HONORS (SELECTED)

- Hans Weisser Fellowship for US Research Stay & Academic Networking on East & West Coast on how to leverage field experiments for more evidence-based climate policies 2023
- Young Global Changer, Global Solutions Group 2022
- Energy Transition PhD fellowship of Academic Merit Foundation of German Businesses* 2020-24
- Scholarship of Academic Merit Foundation of German Protestant Churches* 2009-12

*Part of the league of competitively awarded academic merit scholarships financed by the German ministry of Science and Education funding the top 1 percent of German students